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Travel and Entertainment Policy

Title:	Travel and Entertainment Policy
Policy Owner:	Vice President for Finance and Chief Financial Officer
Applies to:	University Workforce Members, Students, and Guests
Campus Applicability:	All UConn Campuses, except UConn Health
Approval Date:	June 17, 2026
Effective Date:	July 1, 2026
For More Information, Contact:	Associate Vice President for Financial Operations and Controller
Contact Information:	travel@uconn.edu
Official Website:	https://travel.uconn.edu/

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BACKGROUND

The University of Connecticut (University) recognizes and supports the need of members of its community to travel for conferences, events, and other purposes in support of and consistent with the University's mission. The University may also find it important to host guests for similar purposes. This policy addresses the most common aspects of University Business Travel and entertainment.

PURPOSE

To establish rules that balance the University's Business Travel and entertainment needs with the responsible stewardship of public resources, and to make employees and approvers aware of their respective obligations in incurring, seeking reimbursement for and approving travel and/or entertainment expenses.

APPLIES TO

University Workforce Members, students and guests, including but not limited to recruits and job candidates.

DEFINITIONS

Approver: An individual designated to review and/or authorize Business Travel and associated expenses, in compliance with University policies and procedures. See [Appendix 1 Roles and Responsibilities](#) for further details.

Business Expense ("Travel Expenses"): Business Expenses ("Travel Expenses") meet the following criteria:

- Reasonable Expenses: Costs that a prudent person would incur under similar circumstances. They should not be excessive or extravagant and must reflect fair market value.
- Necessary Expenses: Costs essential to conducting official University business. They must directly support the University's objectives and be indispensable for the completion of a specific task or duty.
- Appropriate Expenses: Costs suitable and fitting for the context of the business activity. They should align with the University's mission and adhere to its policies and ethical standards.

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Reimbursement: The repayment of allowable, properly documented out-of-pocket or Travel Card expenses associated with approved Business Travel.

Travel Card: A University-issued credit card used to pay for authorized travel-related expenses incurred during official University business.

Traveler: Anyone traveling on behalf of the University including University Workforce Members, students, guests, recruits and job candidates.

Senior Institutional Official: The appropriate University officer, including the President, Provost, or the Executive Vice President for Finance and Chief Financial Officer, who has authority and responsibility for the area or activity to which the policy applies.

University Workforce Members: Employees, volunteers, trainees, and other persons whose conduct, in the performance of work for the University, is under the direct control of the University, whether or not they are paid by the University.

POLICY STATEMENT

The University reimburses Travel Expenses incurred for official University business when properly authorized and documented pursuant to applicable University policies and procedures, the rules applicable to accountable plans under the Treasury Regulations and, for certain independent contractors, the rules applicable under the Internal Revenue Code. All such expenses must comply with the requirements outlined in this policy and the associated Travel and Entertainment Procedures (“Procedures”).

Workforce members may be subject to additional or differing travel and entertainment requirements under a collective bargaining agreement (CBA) or provisions in their employment agreement. In the event of a conflict between this policy and an applicable CBA or employment agreement, the CBA or employment agreement shall control.

PRE-TRIP

Pre-Approval

Travel requiring airfare or lodging must be pre-approved prior to the start of the trip. Airfare and Lodging expenses incurred without prior approval may not be reimbursed. Please see Procedures for more information on required levels of approval. Approvers must verify that the requested travel meets the criteria of Business Travel, as defined.

All travel related to conferences (i.e., seminars, workshops, retreats, conventions, etc.) must have supporting evidence of the description of the conference, its location and the dates attached to the Concur Request and Expense report relating to the conference.

The decision to reimburse a Traveler for expenses that required pre-approval but was not obtained will be at the sole discretion of Senior Institutional Officials.

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While the University supports international travel to strengthen the University's partnerships in education and research, certain federal regulations must be followed and steps taken to support a compliant trip. Requirements include, but are not limited to, obtaining prior approval for any Business Travel to a sanctioned country. Failure to obtain prior authorization for activities subject to [export control or sanction regulations](#) may result in serious personal liability and dis-allowance of charges by the University.

ELIGIBLE BUSINESS EXPENSES

The following Travel Expenses are eligible for reimbursement or to be incurred on a Travel Card. Unless otherwise stated, Travelers must select the lowest price that meets the Business Travel needs. Refer to the Procedures for additional details.

General Trip Requirements

Eligible reimbursements will only be made to the Traveler who incurred the expense(s).

Expenses paid with credits received from rebates, points, vouchers, etc., are not eligible for Reimbursement regardless of how the credits were earned.

Receipts are required for expenses exceeding:

- \$50 when using a University Issued Travel Card.
- \$25 when using personal funds (out of pocket expense)

Travelers may incur reimbursable expenses before and after actual business dates, defined as travel days. The eligibility of allowable expenses depends on the one-way flight time excluding layovers.

Preceding business start date:

- If the duration of the departure flight is less than (8) hours, Travelers may claim expenses the day immediately preceding the start of University business.
- If the duration of the departure flight exceeds eight (8) hours, Travelers may claim travel-related expenses (e.g., meal per diem, parking, etc.) for up to three (3) days immediately preceding the start of official University business. However, reimbursement will be limited to a maximum of two (2) nights of lodging at the business location.

After the conclusion of business, Travelers may claim related expenses for one (1) travel day following the conclusion of University business.

Long-Term Business Travel

Long-Term Business Travel requests must include a detailed description that explains its necessity to conduct University business.

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- In rare circumstances, the Travel Expenses of a spouse, partner, immediate family member or dependent (“accompanying individual”) may be eligible for reimbursement if the presence of the accompanying individual serves an essential business function.
- The accompanying individual must have a defined, documented, and pre-approved official role that is essential to University business. A detailed justification specifying the official role of the accompanying individual and supporting documentation, such as event programs or correspondence verifying their official role, must be submitted for approval to a Senior Institutional Official prior to travel.
- Expenses incurred without the required documentation or prior approval will not be reimbursed, and the Traveler may be held personally responsible for such expenses.

Combined Business and Personal Travel

Travelers may combine personal travel with approved Business Travel subject to the following requirements and only when authorized in advance by an Approver.

1. When weekends, holidays, or necessary standby days fall between Business Travel days, the University may reimburse lodging and meal expenses only if the Traveler demonstrates cost savings to the University. The determination of cost-savings is made by the University, not the Traveler.
2. Travelers who choose to arrive early or extend their stay for non-business reasons are responsible for all expenses incurred for personal days, including additional airfare expenses due to an additional flight leg or different airport from the business location related to personal travel.

Travelers must clearly document personal travel and separate eligible Travel Expenses from personal expenses.

Transportation

Air Travel

University Workforce Members and students should purchase the lowest commercial airfare available but may also make reasonable allowances for practicality and preferences such as safety, scheduling and any need for special accommodations. First class air travel, refundable tickets and seat upgrades such as Comfort or Economy Plus are not reimbursable. If free seat selection is not available at time of booking, then Reimbursement for seat selection fees up to \$50 per leg is allowed. Baggage fees for up to two checked bags are reimbursable. Overweight baggage fees are not allowed.

- Employees and students must use Concur or the University’s preferred travel agency to book airfare when arranging travel for themselves, guests, or suppliers.
- Guests and suppliers are strongly encouraged to have the University book their travel through Concur or the University’s preferred agency.
- Travelers are required to park at airport economy lots. Central garage parking is not permitted.

Airfare Class

Business class is not allowed. Economy upgrades (i.e., Economy Plus, Comfort plus, etc.) are allowed for

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prolong travel; (4) result in additional costs that would offset the transportation savings; or (5) offer accommodations not adequate for the Traveler's medical needs. The Traveler is responsible for documenting the foregoing exceptions.

Note that the "Fly America Act," 49 U.S.C. 40118, requires all Travelers to use United States air carriers for all air travel and cargo transportation services supported by Federal funds. One exception to this requirement is transportation provided under a bilateral or multilateral "Open Skies" air transport agreement, to which the United States government and the government of a foreign country are parties, and which the Department of Transportation has determined meets the requirements of the Fly America Act.

Ground Travel

Personal Vehicles

Mileage Reimbursement is based on the standard IRS rate and excludes normal commutes between the Traveler's home and their Official Duty Station when traveling during the work week.

- Travelers will not receive Reimbursement for travel from their home to their Official Duty Stations or commuting expenses between local Storrs Campuses
- Travelers will be reimbursed for travel between regional campuses, less their normal commute to their Official Duty Station. This does not include employees that have more than one Official Duty Station e.g., employees that are required to work at UConn and UConn Health.
- Tolls and parking fees are reimbursable.

Rental Cars

- Employees and students must use Concur or the University's preferred travel agency to book rental cars when arranging travel for themselves, guests, or suppliers
- Guests and suppliers are strongly encouraged to have the University book their travel through Concur or the University's preferred agency
- Travelers must reserve an appropriately sized class of vehicle for the number of passengers.
- Prepaid fuel is not reimbursable. Post paid fuel service (i.e., charged after rental) is reimbursable if using the University's preferred rental car supplier.
- Additional insurance and upgrades (e.g., GPS, roadside assistance) are not reimbursable.
 - If there are no cars available from UConn's preferred car rental agency, then additional insurance is reimbursable.

Alternative Transportation

- Rideshare services, or public transit are allowable if the cost is the same or less than mileage and parking fees associated with a rental car or personal vehicle.

Livery Service

Livery service is permitted if using University-preferred livery suppliers on flights departing from the following airport locations:

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- If a University workforce member or department has a state-owned or state-funded (i.e., an automobile allowance/stipend) vehicle, the University Workforce member or department must use the vehicle for Business Travel whenever possible.

Rail Travel

- Business class is allowed for journeys over four (4) hours excluding layovers.
- First-class rail travel is not reimbursable.

Lodging

Lodging expenses cannot exceed the federal per diem lodging rate by more than 50% percent (excluding taxes). Conference hotel rates are allowed to exceed the federal per diem lodging rate by more than fifty percent (excluding taxes) for rooms booked at the conference hotel.

Lodging reimbursement is limited to the equivalent of one bedroom per Traveler on University business. Travelers may choose a multi-bedroom accommodation; however, when additional bedrooms are not required for other Travelers on University business, reimbursement is limited to the equivalent cost of one bedroom. For multi-bedroom accommodations, the reimbursable amount will be capped at:

- 65% of the total cost for a two-bedroom unit,
- 50% of the total cost for a three-bedroom unit,
- 35% of the total cost for a four-bedroom unit.

Any lodging cost above the applicable reimbursable amount is a personal expense and will not be reimbursed. Travelers will not be reimbursed for lodging costs prior to the day of airline departure or after return flight arrival.

Local Lodging is not allowed, unless it is needed for a conference.

Meals

For individual meals only meal per diem amounts will be reimbursed; actual meal costs will not be reimbursed.

- If a meal was provided, the corresponding meal per diem must be deducted by the Traveler.
- The first and last days of travel are reimbursed at 75% of the daily meal per diem rate

For business meals, alcohol restrictions and additional requirements, please see the separate [Payment of Meals Policy](#).

Gratuities and Miscellaneous

Gratuities are reimbursable at a rate not to exceed 20% of the cost.

Travelers may receive reimbursement for miscellaneous business services/charges while traveling on University

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Reimbursements for international travel are based on actual exchange rates documented by receipts or credit card statements.

Passport and visa fees are reimbursable when required for Business Travel and when permitted by the funding source as in the case of a sponsored project. Travel Expenses to obtain or renew a passport or to obtain a visa are not reimbursable.

International Medical and Emergency Evacuation Expenses:

- Medical and emergency evacuation insurance are covered by the University's contracted supplier for travel during Business Travel dates. Any additional insurance purchased is not reimbursable.
- Costs relating to required vaccinations, prescriptions, medical co-pays for Business Travel are reimbursable.

EXPENSE REPORTING

Expense reports must be submitted within 30 days of the Business Travel end-date using Concur.

Prohibited Business Travel Expenses

The following list is not exhaustive. Consult the Travel and Entertainment Procedures and/or with Travel Services for further information.

1. Normal commute mileage
2. Personal items (e.g. toiletries, souvenirs)
3. Alcohol
4. Fines (e.g., parking traffic violations)
5. Expenses paid with credits
6. Accompanying individuals without a legitimate business purpose
7. Expenses without documentation, unless below the thresholds above
8. Trip insurance

Sponsored Program Expenses

Travelers using sponsored program funds for University Travel Expenses are required to educate themselves or consult with Sponsored Program Services on the sponsor-specific travel requirements. Travelers may be subject to more restrictive rules than those paid from non-sponsored University funds and are required to follow the most restrictive rules of the sponsor and the University. The University is not obligated to cover expenses that are not allowable on sponsored programs or denied by the sponsor. Some sponsors, particularly federal granting agencies, may not allow certain expenses that the University typically does. If the expenses meet all conditions of this policy and the associated travel regulations, the University may cover them from non-sponsored funding.

Travelers who work on sponsored projects may be required to disclose University travel costs paid for or reimbursed by an entity other than the University. Refer to the definition of Significant Financial Interests in the [Financial Conflicts of Interest in Research Policy](#).

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Individuals who require accommodations for reasons of health or disability may seek reasonable exceptions to this policy through the University's Department of Human Resources.

ENFORCEMENT

Travelers who do not comply with this policy or its associated procedures may be personally responsible for expenses incurred. Violations of this policy or its associated procedures may also result in appropriate disciplinary measures in accordance with University By-Laws, General Rules of Conduct for All University Employees, applicable collective bargaining agreements, and the University of Connecticut Student Code.

PROCEDURES/APPENDICES

[Travel and Entertainment Procedures](#)
[Appendix 1 Roles and Responsibilities](#)

REFERENCES

[Export Control and Economic Sanctions Policy](#)
[Financial Conflicts of Interest in Research Policy](#)
[Fly America Act](#)
[Payment of Meals Policy](#)
[University's Export Control website](#)
[University Travel Cards](#) | [Travel Services](#)

POLICY HISTORY

Policy created:

Revisions:

06/17/2026 (*Approved by the University Senior Policy Council and President*)
04/20/2026 (*Approved by the University Senior Policy Council*)
11/19/2025 (*Approved by the University Senior Policy Council and President*)
06/30/2021 (*Minor revisions, Approved by Board of Trustees*)
4/29/2020 (*Approved by Board of Trustees*)
12/1/2017 (*Approved by Board of Trustees*)
7/1/2015 (*Approved by Board of Trustees*)
11/1/2012 (*Approved by Board of Trustees*)
3/24/2008 (*Approved by Board of Trustees*)

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